

R5 Feedback Integration Through Reflection

Pillar	Reflection	Difficulty	Level 1
Time Required	30-40 minutes	Group Size	4-10 or individual
Mode	Team facilitation or solo	Format	In-person or remote
Prerequisites	V3 (Structured Feedback Exchange) or C15 (Feedback Culture) helpful but not required	CLOVER ERA Trigger	Feedback received but not integrated, same feedback given repeatedly, disconnect between feedback and behaviour change

Why This Works

THE NEUROSCIENCE

The brain processes feedback through threat detection before learning. When feedback arrives, the amygdala evaluates it for social danger before the prefrontal cortex can extract useful information. This means much of the feedback people receive is emotionally processed but never cognitively integrated. The person remembers how the feedback felt but not what it said.

Structured reflection on feedback creates a second processing pass. When the emotional charge has subsided (usually 24-48 hours later), the prefrontal cortex can re-engage with the content and extract the actionable elements. This exercise provides the framework for that second pass.

The Exercise

Phase 1: The Feedback Inventory (10 minutes)

WHAT TO SAY

"Think about all the feedback you've received in the past 3 months. Formal reviews, informal comments, things colleagues have said, things your manager has noted. Write down every piece of feedback you can remember, both positive and constructive."

Most people can recall 3-5 pieces. Then the critical question:

WHAT TO SAY

"Of those, which ones have you actually acted on? Which ones changed how you work? And which ones did you hear, acknowledge, and then continue exactly as before?"

Phase 2: The Integration Framework (15 minutes)

For each piece of unintegrated feedback, apply three questions:

1. Do I agree with it? (If no, why not? Is my disagreement based on evidence or on defensiveness?)
2. Is it specific enough to act on? (If 'you need to communicate better,' what specifically would better look like?)
3. What would change if I integrated it? (What would I do differently in practice? What would others notice?)

For feedback that passes all three filters, create an implementation intention (connecting to R2):
 "When [trigger situation from the feedback], I will [specific new behaviour]."

Phase 3: The Feedback Request (10 minutes)

WHAT TO SAY

"Integration is not just about processing feedback you've already received. It's about actively seeking the feedback you haven't been given. Think about one area where you suspect you have a blind spot. Who could give you honest feedback about it? Your homework: ask them. Specifically: 'I'm trying to get better at [X]. What do you see me doing that helps or hinders that?'"

Facilitation Notes

Situation	Response
Someone realises they've been ignoring the same feedback for months	Normalise: "Most people do this. The feedback hit an emotional nerve and the brain buried it. That's human. The question is: now that you see the pattern, what are you going to do about it?"
Someone disagrees with feedback they received	"Disagreement is valid. But test it: ask two other people whether they see the same thing. If three people give you the same feedback, the data is worth considering even if your instinct disagrees."

Cross-Pillar Connections

Worksheet	Connection	Direction
V3: Structured Feedback Exchange	V3 teaches the giving/receiving skill. R5 ensures the received feedback actually produces change.	Run V3 before R5
C15: Building a Feedback Culture	C15 builds the system for ongoing feedback. R5 ensures the feedback lands.	Complementary
R2: From Ideas to Action	R5's implementation intentions use R2's methodology.	R5 connects to R2